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Software Developer Apprentice (Band 5/EO)

Health and Safety Executive

Apply before Midday on Tuesday 10th November 2026

Reference number

486343

Salary

£31,657 - £34,570

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Executive Officer
Band 5

Contract type

Permanent
Apprenticeship

Business area

HSE - Information Technology Services (ITS) - HSE - Technology Division

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Ashford (Kent), Basingstoke, Birmingham, Bootle, Bristol, Buxton, Carlisle, Chelmsford, Crewe, Leeds, Milton Keynes, Newcastle-upon-Tyne, Norwich, Nottingham, Oxted, Plymouth, Sheffield, York

About the job

Job summary

Technology, data, and digital services underpins everything that HSE does. We are a knowledge organisation, with a wealth of experience in keeping people safe. It is the responsibility of the Technology Division (TD) to ensure that everyone in the organisation can access our data and information, to share it and to use it to make effective decisions. We support over 3000 colleagues working across Great Britain and, our services keep inspectors functioning effectively and efficiently on industrial sites nationwide, from oil platforms in the North Sea to our deepest mines and quarries.

We strive to constantly improve the technologies and services supporting the organisation. Our end user computing devices are leading edge, and we are making significant progress in delivering new cloud-based services. Our service management and information management services are very highly regarded within the organisation and pride themselves on excellent customer service. Our commercial team has built strong relationships with suppliers and our project management team is embedded in our corporate change programme, transforming the older legacy systems that have underpinned the organisation for a long time.

Please be advised that due to the Apprenticeship component, part-time hours are unavailable for this role.

Please be advised that although this role is being offered under a permanent contract this is on the basis that the successful candidate completes the apprenticeship and maintains satisfactory performance. Failure to pass your apprenticeship within the stated timeframe, may result in the termination of your apprenticeship and, where possible, redeployment to another suitable role within the organisation, in line with our redeployment policy. If there are no suitable roles available, it may be necessary to terminate your employment.

Job description

You will deliver software development solutions and support to major digital and technology services change programmes transforming HSE and, support

the implementation of continuous improvement (CI) and continuous deployment (CD) for services once live.

By converting user requirements into technical requirements, you will ensure that user expectations are accurately reflected in the software products developed. You will write maintainable software solutions to meet the design, ensuring that accessibility and security best practices are adhered to. You will also undertake Test Driven Development (TDD) through unit testing of solutions, to identify and, where necessary, resolve and propose practical solutions. You will create and maintain project documentation, implementing change control to ensure that software development changes may be tracked, and quality risks managed. Practice continuous self-learning to keep up to date with technological developments to enhance relevant skills and take responsibility for own professional development.

Key Responsibilities

As an apprentice Software Developer, you will be paired with engineering colleagues to learn on the job whilst designing, running, and improving software components. You can expect to benefit from training, coaching, and mentoring to help you develop in this role. You will be learning to work to our technical standards writing clean and secure code. Alongside this you will be mentored to help develop a rounded set of skills and supporting knowledge:

Working in a test-driven manner; testing, correcting, and documenting simple programs or scripts.

Building your knowledge of different systems and software implementation.

Providing crucial service support to users with difficulties or issues.

You will be a hard-working and enthusiastic individual with a flexible and collaborative approach to work.

You will be someone who can work well as part of a busy team but are equally comfortable working independently or with limited supervision.

About the Apprenticeship

Alongside your role, you will undergo a Software Developer Level 4 Apprenticeship. For more information on the apprenticeship on offer please see here Software Engineer Level 4 Apprenticeship , QA

You will be supported from day one for your learning and development into this role, ensuring you are supported every step of the way in completing your apprenticeship and getting the experience you need to excel in your new role. Over time, you will grow into your skillset and role and be able to take ownership and responsibility for certain business processes in-line with your development.

Please note, this role can be based in any of the advertised HSE locations however, occasional travel to our Bootle office may be required.

Person specification

Essential Skills and Criteria

The ability to communicate effectively, have a working level of customer service and teamwork skills. (Lead criterion)

Analytical and problem-solving skills with the ability to research and learn new tools and techniques.

Critical thinking and the ability to investigate, evaluate information and reach conclusions.

Ability to follow agreed procedures, work with minimum supervision and use own initiative to organise own workload.

The ability to work with programmes such as MS Office suite, and other systems with ease.

Eligibility

This is a development role so to be eligible to apply, the training and development you receive must provide you with significant new skills and learning. This is an essential requirement for apprenticeship funding and means you must not already hold a similar or higher qualification, be working towards a similar or higher qualification, or be significantly experienced in the Software Development modules.

Entry level qualification requirements:

To be eligible to apply for this role you must have completed a Level 3 Software Development Apprenticeship with QA or hold an equivalent

qualification with another training provider. If you do **not** hold this qualification, you must hold one of the following:

An A-level in Technology or Mathematics.

A BTEC Diploma in IT.

If you hold a similar or higher qualification or are currently working towards a similar or higher qualification in the Software Development modules, any offer of employment will be withdrawn.

You will be asked to provide evidence of the above qualifications or experience if invited to interview.

In addition you must:

Be aged 16 or over (there is no upper age limit).

Have the right to work in the UK and have been ordinarily resident in the UK/EU/EA for 3 consecutive years before starting the apprenticeship.

For candidates aged 19 and over

For this programme, Software Development, in line with the Department for Work and Pensions (DWP) HSE has agreed that it is a learner-led decision to complete Functional Skills (Level 2 Maths and English). This means that if you cannot evidence you have this already, you now have the option to complete the Functional Skills or opt-out if you prefer. We wish to encourage learners to continue with Functional Skills, especially if you feel it would be beneficial in improving your literacy or numeracy skills or it may be helpful for your future career ambitions to have an English and Maths qualification but for this pathway it is not mandatory.

For candidates aged 16-18

You will be required to provide evidence of a level 2 equivalent qualification in Maths and English (i.e., GCSE Grade A-C). If you do not hold or are unable to provide evidence of this, you will be required to undertake Functional Skills exams (Level 2 Maths and English) as part of the apprenticeship programme.

Hybrid Working

At HSE, we are proud to be able to offer our people the opportunity to work in a hybrid way which combines working from home and the office. This is a voluntary, non-contractual arrangement, and your allocated office will be your contractual place of work. There will be a requirement to travel to the office for various activities, e.g., collaborative working, supporting and training colleagues. If hybrid working is suitable for you and your role, you will be expected to attend the office, or other business-related site, for 60% of your working week. The arrangements will be determined primarily by business need, but personal circumstances and other relevant circumstances will also be taken into account.

Therefore, we would encourage candidates to consider if the commute from home to the office is a feasible distance to travel before making an application. Please note that if you are successful, hybrid working will be discussed prior to taking up the post.

Qualifications

Level 3 Software Development Apprenticeship with QA or hold an equivalent qualification with another training provider;
OR
An A-level in Technology or Mathematics;
OR
A BTEC Diploma in IT;

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Changing and Improving

Working Together

Making Effective Decisions

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £31,657, Health and Safety Executive contributes £9,171 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit

Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

- Learning and development tailored to your role
- An environment with flexible working options
- A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity

We invest in our people with;

- Competitive rates of pay
- Access to the highly competitive Civil Service Pension Scheme to which HSE contribute 28.97%, far more than in the private sector
- Family friendly policies and working hours to help balance your home life and career
- Carer friendly policies to help create a supportive working culture
- 185 hours annual holiday increasing to 222 hours after 5 years' service, plus bank holidays and 1-day Civil Service privilege leave (recorded as 7.4 hours in addition to your annual leave balance)
- Parental leave benefits
- As a member of HSE you will gain access to a wide range of fantastic benefits that you can take advantage of such as the Cycle to Work Scheme, E-Gift Cards and Vouchers via our partner EdenRed.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using Success Profiles (opens in a new window), and will assess your Behaviours, Strengths, Ability and Experience.

Upon submitting your short application form, you will be invited to complete a Civil Service numerical test and a Verbal Reasoning Test.

Please complete the online tests as soon as possible, within 24-48 hours is recommended, to allow time to complete your full application.

You must complete the online tests **and** your full application form by **12.00 Midday on Tuesday 10th November 2026**. If you fail to complete the online test and full application form before the deadline, your application will be withdrawn.

Guidance for the test will be available when you are invited to take the test. The tests are administered online and accessed via the CS Jobs website.

If you successfully pass the test, you will then be invited to complete the final stage of your application.

There will be maintenance for online tests on Sunday 1st November 2026. This means you will be unable to access the online tests between 4pm and midnight. Your progress will be saved, and you will be able to continue once the tests are available again.

Application Information

As part of your application, you will be invited to complete an anonymised CV which should include your career history, experience, and qualifications.

Please be advised that the CV is for information purposes only and will not be scored.

You will also be asked to complete an anonymised Personal Statement, of no more than 500 words which demonstrates how you meet the Essential Skills and Criteria of the job advert.

Application Guidance

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply and how to complete a personal statement How to apply

It is recommended that candidates use the STAR approach in your answers - Situation, Task, Action, Result - to structure your example, guidance about the STAR method can be found on gov.uk and, to refer to the Success Profiles Behaviours (Level 2 EO) guide which can also be found on gov.uk

Please access the following link for guidance and further information on the Civil Service Tests, including practice tests: Civil Service online tests - GOV.UK

Sift Information

The sift will take place from week commencing 9th November 2026 and week commencing 16th November 2026 when you will be assessed on your Personal Statement.

Please note that in the event of a high number of applications, an initial sift will be conducted on the Lead Criterion from your Personal Statement:

> **The ability to communicate effectively, have a working level of customer service and teamwork skills.**

Candidates who pass the benchmark for the Lead Criterion will then progress to full sift on their Personal Statement.

Interview Information

Interviews are scheduled to take place from week commencing 30th November 2026 when you will be assessed on the advertised behaviours and, Strength-based questions.

Please be advised that the Lead Behaviour, **Changing and Improving**, will be used to determine outcomes in the event of a tie-break at interview.

Please note the sift and interview dates could be subject to change due to panel availability.

Sponsorship

This role is not open to application from those who will require sponsorship under the points based system. Should you apply for this role and require sponsorship your application will be rejected, and any provisional offers of employment will be withdrawn.

Further Information

Due to the nature of security checks undertaken, applicants must have 3 years continuous residency in the UK up to the date of the application and, Home Office approval for indefinite leave to remain within the UK.

Please note that a Reserve List will be held for the period of up to 12 months. There is no guarantee you will be offered a role from our reserve lists, so if you see a vacancy on Civil Service Jobs that you are interested in, we recommend you apply.

HSE reserve the right to conduct additional checks, including Google and social media checks, when recruiting candidates into a role within HSE. These checks will be carried out in line with the Civil Service Commission Principles and, if used all candidates will be subject to these additional checks.

From 23rd June 2025, if you are successful at interview, as part of your pre-employment checks, HSE s Recruitment Team are required to check your details against the Internal Fraud Hub (IFH), using your personal details name, NINO, and date of birth. If you are included on the database, you will be refused employment**.** If you believe that there has been an error in the inclusion of your data and wish to make an appeal, please contact the CO email box internal.fraud@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Details of the types of internal fraud/dishonesty covered by this process are defined by the Cabinet Office and can be found here Internal Fraud Register privacy notice - GOV.UK

It is the candidate s responsibility to ensure they are aware of the terms and conditions they will adopt should they be successful in their application. For a summary of HSE terms and conditions as part of Civil Service Reform, please see the attached HSE Terms and Conditions document.

Progression through pay ranges is subject to annual pay awards as permitted within annual Civil Service pay remit guidance and negotiations with Trade Unions.

HSE is proud to be a part of the Disability Confidence Scheme (DCS). As a Disability Confident employer, we positively welcome applications from disabled people. We are committed to making workplace adjustments to ensure anyone can participate in the recruitment and selection process.

If, during the application or interview process, you require any assistance due to a disability or a medical condition, please contact us at the email address below to discuss how we can support you. For example, if you have a disability, and you need an application form in an alternative format or you would like to know more about our recruitment process, please contact: HR.Resourcing-Team@hse.gov.uk

If successful in securing your role, HSE can provide suitable workplace adjustments to support you throughout your career with HSE.

Any move to HSE from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility here

Please note, if you are a current civil servant and you are currently undergoing any of the following formal actions your application will not be progressed any further; Formal discipline action, any formal action regarding attendance, poor performance or any restriction of duties as a result of disciplinary action.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	Technology Division Divisional Support Team
Email :	td.dst@hse.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email :	hr.resourcing-team@hse.gov.uk

Further information

If you believe that Civil Service Commission principles of selection for appointment on merit on the basis of Fair and Open competition have not been met you can raise a complaint by emailing: HR.Resourcing-Team@hse.gov.uk or by writing to HSE at the following address: HSE Resourcing Team 2.3, Redgrave Court, Merton Road, Bootle, Merseyside L20 7HS. If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the

Department, you can contact Civil Service commissioners: https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/code/civilservicecodecomplaints/

Civil Service Commission

disability confident LEADER